

— LIVING OFF THE GRID —

THE SURVIVAL BIBLE

THE FIRST 72 HOURS EMERGENCY CHECKLIST

FREE
COMPANION
GUIDE

— DANIEL B. ANDERSON —

Build your plan before you need it.

Use this guide for a short disruption at home or an evacuation. Prepare for your local hazards.

- ☐ **Count everyone:** adults, children, guests and pets. List needs that cannot wait.
- ☐ **Check what you own:** gather supplies before buying duplicates.
- ☐ **Choose two storage spots:** a home supply area and an easy-to-reach go-bag.
- ☐ **Complete your household plan** on page 8, then share it with everyone.
- ☐ **Practice once:** find the kit, contact your person and rehearse leaving safely.

Household members / pets

Home kit location / go-bag location

72 hours is a starting point.

Some emergencies last much longer. Add supplies over time as space and budget allow. Follow local alerts and evacuation orders; do not wait for this checklist to be complete.

How to use: Check boxes and type in fields in a PDF app that supports forms. Save a copy after editing, or print and write by hand. Page 9 is a low-ink fridge copy.

Stock three days of essentials.

Start with familiar food and sealed drinking water. Plan for every person in your home. [1, 2]

WATER TARGET

People x 3 = gallons for 72 hours.

Use at least 1 gallon per person per day for drinking and sanitation. Add extra for heat, pregnancy, illness and pets.

People: ____ x 3 = ____ gallons minimum

Example: 4 people = at least 12 gallons.
Store water in food-safe containers.



- ☐ Set aside drinking water; label storage dates and check containers for leaks.
- ☐ Pack three days of shelf-stable, ready-to-eat food for each person.
- ☐ Choose foods that meet allergies, dietary needs and usual portion sizes.
- ☐ Add a manual can opener, utensils and food for babies or pets as needed.
- ☐ Write a simple menu so the supply is enough for three full days.

Water advisory? Follow the local instructions.

Use sealed bottled water if the supply is unsafe. Boiling does not remove fuel or toxic chemicals. Do not use suspect water until officials explain what is safe.

Keep the home safe during outages.

Choose reliable lighting, charged devices and protection from the weather. [1, 3]

- ☐ Flashlights or headlamps, plus matching spare batteries.
- ☐ Charged power banks and the correct phone cables.
- ☐ Battery or hand-crank radio; write down a local station.
- ☐ Blankets, dry layers, sturdy shoes and rain protection.



- ☐ Test smoke alarms and battery-backed carbon monoxide alarms.
- ☐ Identify a safe place to go if the home becomes too hot, cold or damaged.
- ☐ Keep emergency lighting and shoes where you can find them in the dark.

Generators stay outdoors.

Keep portable generators at least 20 feet from doors, windows and vents, with exhaust directed away. Never run one in a garage, even with the door open.

No indoor camp stoves or grills.

Use battery lights. Never use a gas oven for heat. If a carbon monoxide alarm sounds, get outside and call 911.

Plan for the needs you cannot pause.

Build around your household, including children, older adults, disabilities and pets. [2, 4]

- ☐ First-aid kit with dressings, bandages, gloves and instructions.
- ☐ Personal medications and an up-to-date medication / allergy list.
- ☐ Glasses, hearing-aid batteries and other essential daily supplies.



- ☐ Ask your pharmacist about an emergency supply and safe medication storage.
- ☐ Plan backup power and help for essential medical or mobility equipment.
- ☐ Pack soap, sanitizer, toilet paper, hygiene items and sturdy waste bags.
- ☐ Add diapers, feeding supplies and comfort items for children as needed.
- ☐ Pack pet food, water, medicine, waste supplies, leash and carrier.

Make a care backup plan.

Name someone who can help and a safe destination if power or care is interrupted. For immediate danger or a serious medical emergency in the U.S., call 911.

Pack a bag you can actually carry.

Keep bulky home supplies separate. Your go-bag supports the trip to a safer destination. [1, 2, 5]

- ☐ Accessible water and easy-to-eat food for the journey.
- ☐ Medication, glasses and essential personal care supplies.
- ☐ Phone, cable, power bank, light and a whistle.
- ☐ Seasonal clothing, sturdy shoes and a compact blanket.



- ☐ Waterproof copies of ID, insurance details and important contacts.
- ☐ Keys, a paper map and small bills you can afford to set aside.
- ☐ Supplies for pets and children; confirm where they can stay.
- ☐ A transport plan, a backup route and someone to help if needed.

Practice the carry test.

Lift your bag and walk with it. Adjust the load for each person. Follow official routes and evacuation orders; never walk or drive through floodwater.

Your first-three-days action guide.

These are check-in windows, not waiting periods. Act sooner whenever danger or official instructions require it.

RIGHT AWAY / PROTECT PEOPLE

- ☐ Check immediate hazards and get everyone to safety. Call 911 for emergencies.
- ☐ Read local alerts. Follow shelter or evacuation instructions.
- ☐ Send your contact a short update with your location and next check-in.

FIRST DAY / SET A ROUTINE

- ☐ Gather the kit. Note the outage start time and keep fridge doors closed.
- ☐ Review water, food, medication and each person's care needs.
- ☐ Set check-in times and conserve phone power.

DAYS 2-3 / REASSESS

- ☐ Check official updates and the safety of your location again.
- ☐ Count remaining supplies and arrange safe resupply or shelter early.
- ☐ Record what needs replacing. Keep checking on everyone.

Food safety during an outage [3]

A closed refrigerator keeps food cold for about 4 hours. Discard perishable food after that unless kept at 40 F or below. Never taste food to test safety.

Your household emergency plan

Keep copies with each person. Store sensitive medical and identity documents securely. [5]

Household name / date reviewed

Out-of-area contact: name + phone

Nearby meeting place (when safe to use)

Meeting place outside the neighborhood

Evacuation destination + phone / confirm pets and accessibility

Transport + backup route / person who can help

Local alert source / radio station / planned check-in times

Care needs + helper / medication or equipment plan location

Next kit review date / missing priority item

72-hour fridge checklist

Check each item when it is packed or planned. Review supplies every six months and after use. [1, 2]

SUPPLIES

- ☐ Water: at least 3 gallons per person, plus extra needs and pets.
- ☐ Three days of food; manual opener; baby / pet supplies.
- ☐ Lights, batteries, radio, power bank and charging cables.
- ☐ Medication, first aid, hygiene supplies and essential care items.
- ☐ Clothes, shoes, blankets, keys, cash and document copies.

PLAN

- ☐ Meeting places, contact person and alert source written down.
- ☐ Safe destination, transport and backup route identified.
- ☐ Go-bags packed; each person knows the kit location.
- ☐ Pet, disability and medical support arrangements confirmed.

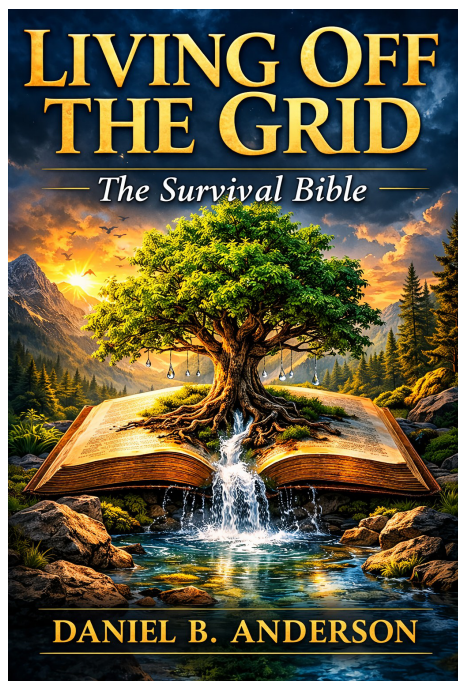
Emergency contact + phone

Meeting place / destination

Immediate danger: follow local instructions. Call 911 for emergencies.
Never: run generators indoors, use camp stoves inside, or enter floodwater.

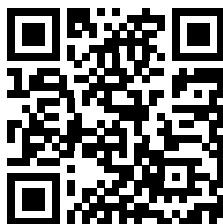
Preparedness starts with one step.

You have a starting checklist. Keep practicing, improving and learning as a household.



GO BEYOND THE FIRST 72 HOURS

Explore water, food, shelter, energy, sanitation and longer-term preparedness in **Living Off the Grid: The Survival Bible** by Daniel B. Anderson.



Explore the full guide
Scan the code or tap the link below.

guide.survivalbibleguide.com

REFERENCE NOTES

1. Ready.gov - Build a Kit
2. American Red Cross - Survival Kit Supplies
3. CDC - Protect Yourself During a Power Outage
4. Texas Ready - Disaster Supply Checklist
5. Texas Ready - Make a Plan

Reference titles are clickable. Prepared September 2026. General U.S. preparedness guidance; follow current local emergency instructions and individual medical advice. Illustrations are atmospheric, not equipment-use instructions.

Free companion edition. You may share this complete, unaltered PDF for free and print copies for personal use. Not for resale. Text and imagery drawn from the author's project materials, with updated checklist guidance.

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